

don't have a million distributors either, so where's the online product catalogue and shopping cart?

Product Pricing

Yes, it's pointless to set up an online shop if your products cost a lakh a piece. Considering that the average credit card holder's credit limit is between Rs 30,000 and Rs 40,000, any products that cost in excess of Rs 20,000 might not be so hot online. If your products are FMCGs, and cost anywhere from a few hundred rupees to a few thousand, you should definitely consider an online shop.

Shipping

Don't make the mistake of thinking that since you only service a single city, an online shop wouldn't help. You will need to mention clearly that delivery is only within your city, and not let it deter you from setting up your e-shop. You could always put up a "Dealers Wanted" sign on your site and try and expand into more cities eventually.

The Checklist

Before you go about getting a Payment Gateway, you need to identify your needs. If you have a variety of products, you will need to set up a product catalogue and a shopping cart service.

In this issue, we have shown you how to set up a PHP Web site (page 62). If you are setting up a Web site using that advice, you will find that adding a shopping cart is quite simple—all you need to do is find a shopping cart module for PHP-Nuke that fits your needs, and add it to your Web site.

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The first thing you need to do is register at CCavenue.com

The Payment Gateway

The payment gateway is sort of like a broker for all deals between you and your customers. It will authenticate your customer's credit or debit card and then bill it for the specified amount. This money is then deposited into your account on a weekly or monthly basis.

The important thing to keep in mind is that you will need to bill your customers in the local currency, as you don't want customers not buying your products just because the price is mentioned in dollars. Though there are many companies offering payment gateway services, we will just take one example for the purpose of this article.